The `SelectListItem` object defines a `Group` property that specifies the `SelectListGroup` the item belongs to. The following listing shows how you could create two groups and assign each list item to a "dynamic" or "static" group, using a `PageModel` similar to that shown in listing 18.5. The final list item, `C#`, isn't assigned to a group, so it will be displayed as normal, without an `<optgroup>`.

Listing 18.7 Adding `Groups` to `SelectListItems` to create `optgroup` elements

```
public class SelectListsModel: PageModel
{
    [BindProperty]
    public IEnumerable<string> SelectedValues { get; set; }        ❶
    public IEnumerable<SelectListItem> Items { get; set; }

    public SelectListsModel()                                      ❷
    {
        var dynamic = new SelectListGroup { Name = "Dynamic" };    ❸
        var @static = new SelectListGroup { Name = "Static" };     ❸
        Items = new List<SelectListItem>
        {
            new SelectListItem {
                Value= "js",
                Text="Javascript",
                Group = dynamic                                    ❹
            },
            new SelectListItem {
                Value= "cpp",
                Text="C++",
                Group = @static                                    ❹
            },
            new SelectListItem {
                Value= "python",
                Text="Python",
                Group = dynamic                                    ❹
            },
            new SelectListItem {                                   ❺
                Value= "csharp",                                   ❺
                Text="C#",                                         ❺
            }
        };
    }
}
```

❶ Holds the selected values where multiple selections are allowed